

Must vs Have to

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

'Must' and 'have to' both mean obligation. Choose by where the obligation comes from:

- 1 Must — from the speaker: a personal need or a rule you're stating (You must be quiet).
- 2 Have to — from outside: laws, rules, jobs, circumstances (I have to work late).

For the past, always use 'had to'. And remember: 'mustn't' = forbidden, 'don't have to' = not necessary.

At a glance

	Must	Have to
Obligation from	the speaker (feeling / stated rule)	outside (law, job, others)
Past form	— (use <i>had to</i>)	had to
Negative	mustn't = forbidden	don't have to = not necessary
Example	I must call the doctor.	I have to wear a uniform.

Learning objectives

- Can choose between 'must' and 'have to' by source of obligation (CEFR B1).
- Can use 'had to' as the only past form.
- Can contrast 'mustn't' (prohibition) and 'don't have to' (no necessity).

Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Must vs Have to · CEFR B1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. I keep oversleeping. I really ____ buy a louder alarm.

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| A. must | B. have to |
| C. had to | D. must to |

2. At my company, we ____ clock in by nine.

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| A. must to | B. have to |
| C. must | D. had to |

3. Yesterday the car broke down, so I ____ take the bus.

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| A. must | B. have to |
| C. had to | D. must to |

4. It's a secret. You ____ tell anyone.

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| A. don't have to | B. mustn't |
| C. must | D. have to |

5. It's a casual party — you ____ dress up.

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| A. mustn't | B. don't have to |
| C. must | D. have to |

6. She ____ wear glasses for driving; it's on her licence.

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| A. has to | B. have to |
| C. must to | D. haves to |

7. Which comes from an OUTSIDE rule?

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|--------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| A. I must eat more vegetables. | B. You have to be 18 to vote. |
| C. I must call my sister. | D. We must tidy up soon. |

8. Correct this: 'Last week I must finish two reports.'

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| A. Last week I had to finish two reports. | B. Last week I must to finish two reports. |
| C. Last week I have to finish two reports. | D. The sentence is already correct. |

9. Passengers ____ fasten their seatbelts during take-off.

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| A. don't have to | B. must |
| C. mustn't | D. must to |

10. The ticket is already paid, so you ____ bring any money.

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| A. mustn't | B. don't have to |
| C. must | D. have to |

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. must** — A personal feeling takes 'must': 'I must buy a louder alarm'.
2. **B. have to** — A workplace rule (from outside) takes 'have to': 'we have to clock in'.
3. **C. had to** — Past obligation takes 'had to': 'I had to take the bus'.
4. **B. mustn't** — Prohibition takes 'mustn't': 'You mustn't tell anyone'.
5. **B. don't have to** — No necessity takes 'don't have to': 'You don't have to dress up'.
6. **A. has to** — An external rule + 'she' gives 'has to': 'She has to wear glasses'.
7. **B. You have to be 18 to vote.** — A law (from outside) takes 'have to': 'You have to be 18 to vote'.
8. **A. Last week I had to finish two reports.** — Past obligation takes 'had to': 'Last week I had to finish two reports'.
9. **B. must** — A stated safety rule takes 'must': 'Passengers must fasten their seatbelts'.
10. **B. don't have to** — No necessity takes 'don't have to': 'You don't have to bring any money'.